

ered. The menu system is strictly so-so, as are the buttons which feel tacky. We first saw issues with contrast under DisplayMate, where this monitor missed out on



a lot of grey cards in the Intensity Range Check. Some issues with line and point shape tests in the geometry gamut of tests mean that professional users steer clear of this one. In games there's a noticeable lack in contrast, particularly in F.E.A.R which is merciless with most mediocre LCDs. With mediocre performance in the movie tests the IT1904W certainly isn't a bad performer, its just that there are too many individual little flaws to really recommend it, even at a sterling price of Rs 9,500.

LG W1952 TQ-PF

Fancy, but performance-free

A good looking monitor with a very slim bezel and compact stand the W1952 TQ stands out because of its simplicity of design. It performs below par in the contrast ratio tests, and does a little better at the colour tests in DisplayMate. With barely acceptable performance in F.E.A.R and in the movie tests particularly in the



contrast and colour department, this monitor isn't the best choice for multimedia aficionados. At Rs 12,000 it's a little too costly for the performance it offers...look

elsewhere

LG W1942 T

Simply functional

The second monitor from LG in this category, and definitely as good looking. It's built well too, and the menu system and buttons are very easy to work with. In DisplayMate we noticed some issues with contrast but it wasn't as bad as its sibling. In the colour tests we noticed some issues with



rendition of red, but this isn't very noticeable in everyday use. It performed decidedly better in our gaming and movie tests—although we did notice some issues with contrast, especially in F.E.A.R and its shadowy environs. Priced at Rs 9,400 it's cheaper than its sibling, and better performing. Its one of those inexpensive purchases that you can't go wrong with, especially if you're building any sort of home PC.

NEC MultiSync 1990 SX

A price welcome to S-IPS land

This LCD sports the only S-IPS panel we received and the industry grade build quality makes no bones about its focus audience. The matte black finish looks very boring on this monitor and the humongous stand doesn't help. The stand is adjustable for height and pivots to portrait mode as well. The ultra slim bezel looks great. Calibrating this monitor proved easy, and aside from a couple of missing grey cards we could see them all. Colour rendition was excellent as is to be expected, and this monitor performed flawlessly in the reverse text tests as well. When it comes to games like F.E.A.R this monitor excels at reproducing colour and contrast, no issues, except for a little pixel response lag courtesy the slower response time specification. It's pretty decent for watching movies, but at Rs 42,000 you could buy



a 32-inch TV for the same. It really shines for discerning professionals, but despite the astronomical performance we still feel it's overpriced by a good bit.

NEC MultiSync 1970NXP

Bulky Beast

Based around an MVA panel the 1970NXP is another bulky looking monitor like its costlier sibling. In DisplayMate whatever its sibling did it did with a little less performance. There was very little discernable performance gap in the contrast and geometry tests where both monitors excel, but in the colour tests we could make out a difference between



the two which is where its costlier brother really earns its stripes. In games like F.E.A.R you'll be able to play with all the detail available even in the darkest areas of the screen, and it outshines its excellent sibling. It also sports excellent viewing angles, the types TN panel based monitors can only dream about. At Rs 28,900 the 1970NXP is excellent but sadly grossly overpriced. We reckon NEC needs to seriously look at its pricing of these brilliant monitors in India—and as a result we cannot recommend the 1970NXP

for anyone, including professionals for whom there are better choices as you will see.

Samsung 943NXW

Touch me!

Touch controls look so ooh!—a pity they don't work the same way, and we found a brilliant design, menu layout and fit and finish let down by quirky touch controls. In DisplayMate this panel proved to be a let-down of sorts after their excellent 2253LW—it misses out on a lot of the contrast, particularly



with dark shades and intensely bright shades i.e. both opposite ends of the intensity spectrum. In movies we liked the fact that it's widescreen, but the issue with contrast once again rears its ugly head. While gaming, we noticed shadows appearing as blotches at times—another contrast ratio issue. Priced at Rs 12,500, we feel it's a bit too expensive for the performance. The only real thing this monitor has going for it is aesthetics.

Samsung 953BW

Simple goodness

It's not unusual to find a cheaper priced product that proves to be a better performer overall, so do perk up at this point. The 953BW shares the same tasteful design of the 2253LW. Running DisplayMate first we noticed better performance than its costlier sibling, and a contrast ratio that seemed anywhere between five and ten per cent better. DisplayMate decrees that this panel has issues with green on a grey and black background in the reverse text tests. Movie watching is fun on this monitor as was gaming, with a decent contrast ratio the overall experience while playing F.E.A.R was acceptable if not exemplary. At Rs 10,000 this



953BW is cheaper than most of its 19-inch brethren and makes a good choice for anyone building a multimedia PC. Its looks will ensure it's at home on a corporate desktop as well.

ViewSonic VA1912W

Old and going strong

This is another monitor from last years' lot, and its age shows. Its very simple looking, archaic even, and hardly anything about the build quality will inspire or appeal. A few minutes into DisplayMate's tests revealed some geometry issues in the line and point shape and visibility



tests. Next up, the contrast ratio was something that we felt could improve a good bit. It ran through the colour gamut tests without serious incident, but not without a couple of incidents in the 16 shade ramp test and the colour purity tests. For gaming this monitor is a mixed bag—it has decent colours, although not as good as the Samsung 953 BW, and while the contrast ratio is also inferior to the 953BW it's not totally unacceptable. This scenario is identical for movies. At Rs 9,650, it is cheap, but not as cheap as the identical performing LG W1942T, though you could pay four hundred rupees more for something much better (the Samsung 953BW).

ViewSonic VX1940W

When new isn't good

This is a newer monitor, but doesn't feel as solid in build as its older sibling. It has that built-to-a-budget feel and look to it. Neck deep in DisplayMate's geometry tests we had some issues with the point and line tests, and later with the contrast tests where, try as we might, we couldn't spot



much of the grey cards in a black background in the Intensity Range Check tests. In the colour tests, we ran into some problems with the 16 and 64 shade tests, where the monitor kept missing out on certain intensities especially at the brighter-end of things. Gaming isn't the experience we wanted it to be, not that this was unexpected, considering the performance in DisplayMate. Movies also show a contrast issue, although the colours aren't too bad. At Rs 10,650 the VX1940W isn't the cheapest monitor around, nor is it the best performing. The fact that the cheaper Samsung 953BW outshines it in nearly every test is reason enough to stay away from it.

20 inch LCD monitors Middlemen

BenQ T201WA

Plain Jane, but a good pane

The T201WA has a nicely curved front bezel that immediately looks Jurassic because of its width. Finished in silver, the largish buttons in a neat row work well, but look and feel tacky. The large stand with curved sides is square and appears squat, whether its okay looking or downright ugly is up to you to decide. First up DisplayMate ran into issues during calibration, where the Intensity Range Check lost a lot of grey cards. While adjusting